Troubleshooting Guide

Reservation Overbookings

Document Type	Internal Troubleshooting Guide
Product	EchoCRS — Reservation Management
Audience	L1 / L2 Support Engineers
Related Tools	Kibana, Splunk, Reservation Reports
Version	1.0

Overview

This guide provides structured troubleshooting steps for investigating reported reservation overbooking incidents within EchoCRS. Overbookings can occur across transient (individual) and group booking types and may involve a range of system, timing, configuration, or third-party factors.

Support engineers should work through the appropriate section below based on the booking type reported. Each section includes an information-gathering checklist followed by a sequential investigation workflow.

ℹ INFO	All timestamp comparisons must be normalized to the property's local time zone and then converted to Central Time before analysis. Failing to account for time zone offsets is a common source of incorrect overbooking assessments.

Section 1 — Transient Booking Overbookings

Use this section when the reported overbooking involves an individual (transient) reservation, including bookings made via direct channels, OTAs (Online Travel Agencies), or GDS connections.

Step 1 — Gather Required Information

Before beginning investigation, collect the following details from the client:

Transient Booking — Information Checklist	
☐	Property CRS ID, Business ID, and time zone
☐	Reservation ID (CRS and/or PMS reference)
☐	Stay dates of the booking in question
☐	Date and time of the booking (exact, with time zone)

☐	Booking source (direct, OTA name, GDS, etc.)
☐	Room name, room code, and room ID
☐	Time of last inventory message received prior to booking
☐	Time of first inventory message received after booking

Step 2 — Investigate Inventory Messages

Once information is gathered, follow the steps below in order. Do not skip steps.

1. Confirm the property time zone and convert all relevant timestamps to Central Time.
2. In Kibana, locate the last inventory message received prior to the reported booking. Note the timestamp.
   - → If the last message shows 0 availability → proceed to Step 3.
   - → If the last message shows availability → the system had availability at time of booking. Advise the client accordingly and document findings.
3. To further validate, locate the first inventory message received after the booking in Kibana. Note the timestamp.
4. If the booking appears valid based on inventory messages, check for cancellations.
   - → Review cancellations that occurred between the time of the last pre-booking inventory message and the time of the booking.
   - → If cancellations are found → the overbooking is not valid. Advise the client with supporting data.
   - → If no cancellations are found → proceed to Step 5.
5. Check property configuration: confirm whether Include Hold Bookings in Available Count is enabled.
   - → If the setting is NOT enabled → enable it, advise the client that a configuration change has been made, and note that this should prevent recurrence.
   - → If the setting IS already enabled → this case is a candidate for L3 escalation. Proceed to Step 6 only if the booking source was an OTA.
6. For OTA-sourced bookings only: confirm the time range between the last inventory message and the booking time.
   - → OTA platforms can take up to 15 minutes to receive and process ARI (Availability, Rates, and Inventory) updates.
   - → If the OTA booking was processed within a 15-minute window after the last inventory update, insufficient time may have elapsed for the OTA to receive the updated availability.
   - → For bookings via Channel Management: engage the channel management team to review OTA submissions.
   - → For Expedia Quick Connect bookings: submission-level access is not available; document and escalate accordingly.

⚠ ESCALATION	If Steps 1–6 do not produce a clear root cause, escalate to L3 with your Kibana log exports, timestamps, cancellation review results, and configuration findings attached.

Section 2 — Group Booking Overbookings

Use this section when the reported overbooking involves a group reservation. Group bookings operate on separate inventory logic and may use dedicated block allocations (Non-Elastic) or draw from general inventory as a fallback (Elastic).

Understanding Group Inventory Types

Type	Behavior
Non-Elastic	Draws only from the group block allocation. No spillover into general inventory.
Elastic	Draws from the group block first, then falls back to general inventory once the group allocation is depleted (if an allocation was assigned).

Step 1 — Gather Required Information

Before beginning investigation, collect the following details from the client:

Group Booking — Information Checklist	
☐	Property CRS ID, Business ID, and time zone
☐	Group block code
☐	Group configuration type (Non-Elastic or Elastic)
☐	Reservation ID (CRS and/or PMS reference)
☐	Stay dates of the booking in question
☐	Date and time of the booking (exact, with time zone)
☐	Booking source
☐	Room name, room code, and room ID
☐	Time of last group inventory message received prior to booking
☐	Time of first group inventory message received after booking

Step 2 — Investigate Inventory Messages

1. Confirm the property time zone and convert all relevant timestamps to Central Time.

2. Confirm the group configuration type (Non-Elastic or Elastic). This determines which inventory pool to investigate in Kibana.

3. In Kibana, locate the last group inventory message received prior to the reported booking. Note the timestamp.

→ If the last message shows 0 availability → the system had no group availability at time of booking. Proceed to Step 4.

→ If the last message shows availability → the system had availability at time of booking. Advise the client accordingly and document findings.

4. To further validate, locate the first group inventory message received after the booking. Note the timestamp.

5. If the booking appears valid based on inventory messages, check for cancellations.
   - → Review cancellations that occurred between the time of the last pre-booking inventory message and the time of the booking.
   - → If cancellations are found → the overbooking is not valid. Advise the client with supporting data.
   - → If no cancellations are found → this case is a candidate for L3 escalation. Document all findings and proceed to escalation.

⚠ ESCALATION	If the root cause cannot be determined after completing Steps 1–5, escalate to L3. Include Kibana log exports, the group block code, configuration type, all relevant timestamps, and cancellation review results.

Section 3 — Escalation Quick Reference

Use the table below to determine when to escalate and what to include in the escalation package.

Condition	Action	What to Include
No cancellations found; inventory messages show valid overbooking	**Escalate to L3**	Kibana logs, timestamps, cancellation review
Include Hold Bookings setting already enabled; cause unclear	**Escalate to L3**	Configuration screenshot, Kibana logs, case summary
OTA booking outside 15-minute ARI window; Channel Mgmt can't confirm	**Escalate to L3**	Booking timestamp, last ARI message timestamp, OTA source
Group overbooking; no cancellations; all steps exhausted	**Escalate to L3**	Group block code, config type, Kibana logs, timestamps

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